

STARTUP INFINITY NEWSLETTER

FEBRUARY 2025



Industry Peer Group Roundtable – Food Industry Cohort

18th February 2025 | Taj Dubai, Business Bay

The Industry Peer Group Roundtable, hosted at Taj Dubai, brought together policymakers, investors, and industry leaders to strengthen UAE-India collaboration in the food processing and agritech sector. The event was graced by Shri. Chirag Paswan, Hon. Cabinet Minister of Food Processing Industries, Government of India, as the Chief Guest, and H.E. Satish Sivan, Hon. ConsulGeneral of India, Dubai, as the Guest of Honour.



Key Takeaways

- Shri. Chirag Paswan emphasized the role of mentorship and corporate collaborations in bridging the gap between emerging startups and established businesses. He highlighted the Food Industry Cohort's potential in providing access to research, industry mentorship, and market testing.
- H.E. Satish Sivan pointed out that the food sector contributes \$3 billion to India- UAE bilateral trade, with growing opportunities for food-tech startups and sustainable supply chains.
- Mr. Sameer K Mohamed, MD, Jaleel Holdings, reaffirmed his commitment to supporting startups and highlighted supply chain challenges that need innovative solutions.
- Mr. Suresh Vaidhyanathan, CEO, Abu Dhabi Food Hub, stressed the importance of structured investments and trade bridges between UAE and India to enhance food security. He noted that India's \$85 billion trade volume with the UAE offers immense potential for food and value-added products.

He encouraged startups to disrupt traditional models and introduce sustainable practices.

● Mr. Vaibhav Kothari, SVP, Gulf Islamic Investments (GII), emphasized the strong growth potential for food innovation in the region. He stated, “It’s a win- win for all stakeholders—investors, governments, and businesses. GII is deeply invested in this segment and looking forward to more participation.”

The event featured an interactive Q&A session, where industry leaders, policymakers, and investors engaged in meaningful discussions on policies, investment opportunities, and ecosystem growth.

Unlock Opportunities with the Food Industry Cohort – Apply Now!

The Food Industry Cohort, powered by Jaleel Holdings LLC & Kerala Startup Mission, is a startup market acceleration program designed to foster innovation, strategic partnerships, and investment in the food sector.



Who Can Apply?

Startups in food-tech, agritech, sustainable packaging, and supply chain innovation.

What’s in It for You?

Mentorship, networking, investor connections, and access to Middle East market expansion programs.

Ready to scale?

APPLY NOW



Scaleup in the UAE Roadshow – Kerala Chapter

Trivandrum | Kochi | Calicut

The Scaleup in the UAE Roadshow, organized by Startup Infinity, successfully facilitated connections between 250+ startups and SMEs from Kerala with key industry experts and investors, unlocking new opportunities for business expansion in the UAE.



The event featured insightful sessions on UAE's startup ecosystem, investment avenues, free trade zones, business incorporation, and market entry strategies for sectors like technology and food. Experts shared guidance on government incentives, regulatory frameworks, and mentorship programs designed to support startups looking to establish a foothold in the region.



Industry leaders, including, Mr. Johnson George (General Manager, UAQ Free Trade Zone), Mr. Kevin Fernandes (Director of Commercials, UAQ Free Trade Zone), and Mr. Sameh Magdi (Senior Business Development Executive, UAQ Free Trade Zone), and Mr. Siby Sudhakaran (CEO, Startup Middle East) provided deep insights into business setup, funding, and strategic expansion in the UAE.



The Scaleup in the UAE Roadshow successfully provided Kerala-based startups and SMEs with valuable knowledge and connections to facilitate their expansion into the UAE. The sessions were highly engaging, with enthusiastic participation

from entrepreneurs eager to explore international opportunities. The discussions and networking opportunities have sparked interest in further collaborations and business growth initiatives. A total of 250 participants attended the sessions across all locations, reinforcing the growing interest in UAE market expansion among Kerala's startup and business community.

Industry Meetup:



Mr. Bala addressing the entrepreneurs in Trivandrum



Mr. Sameh Magdi addressing the entrepreneurs in Kochi



Scaleup Index 2025 – Join the Survey!

Startup Infinity presents the Scaleup Index 2025, an exclusive survey designed to map the journey of startups in the GCC region. This initiative aims to gather insights on startups operating in or exploring opportunities within the UAE and other GCC countries.

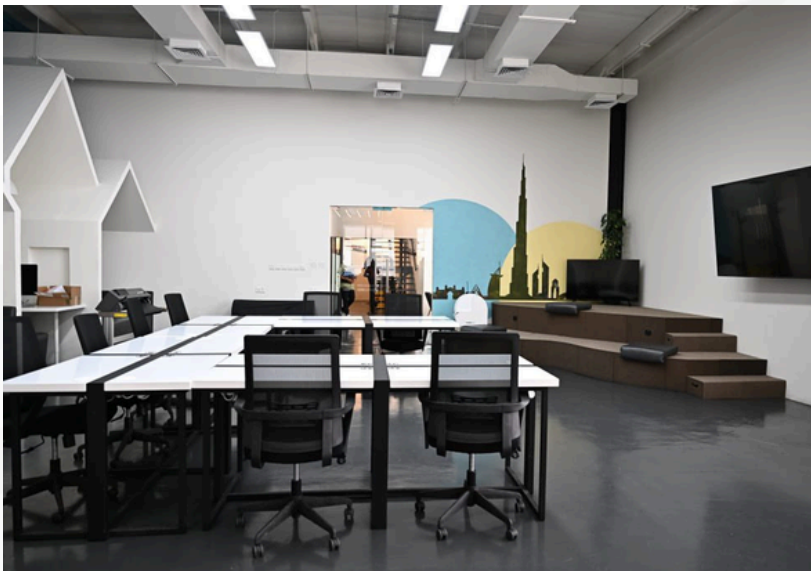
We want to understand your startup's growth, including its registration, business presence, expansion plans, affiliations with incubators or accelerators, and funding received from GCC-based venture capital firms. Your participation will help shape better resources and strategic support for founders like you.

Be part of this transformative initiative to map the journey of startups in the Middle East market.

[REGISTER NOW](#)

Be Part of Startup Infinity Dubai

The Startup Infinity (SI) Desk is a dedicated platform for NRIs and startups to establish and expand their businesses. It offers company registration support, access to Kerala's tech talent, co-founder matchmaking, and strategic partnerships.



Startups from Kerala can leverage global market access, while international startups get three months of free workspace to explore the Indian market. With investor connect programs, business workshops, and support from Startup Middle East, SI Desk is set to be a vibrant hub for global startup growth.

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